BENJAMIN BRANSON BOOKKEEPING

# 10 Signs Your Books Are Costing You Money

A five-minute check for QuickBooks Online owners · By Benjamin Branson, MBA, Odessa, Texas

Tick each one that sounds like your books. Any tick is worth a closer look. The "check" line shows where to look in QuickBooks.

- [ ] **1. The same bill or expense shows up twice.**
A bill entered by hand and again from the bank feed gets paid twice, and nothing flags it. **Check:** run Expenses by Vendor for last month and look for the same vendor, date and amount twice.

- [ ] **2. Money is sitting in "Uncategorized" or "Ask My Accountant."**
Nobody decided what it was for, so your profit and tax records are guesses. **Check:** Chart of Accounts, look for those names with a balance.

- [ ] **3. Personal spending is mixed in with the business.**
It lowers your profit on paper and raises questions at tax time. **Check:** scan last month's card and bank transactions for anything you wouldn't put on a business plan.

- [ ] **4. A bank account shows a negative balance in QuickBooks.**
Often a deposit was never recorded or a payment hit the wrong account, so the number you decide with is wrong. **Check:** Balance Sheet, Bank Accounts.

- [ ] **5. "Opening Balance Equity" has a balance.**
It is a holding account from setup. A balance means starting numbers were never assigned where they belong. **Check:** Balance Sheet, Equity section.

- [ ] **6. Your bank accounts haven't been reconciled lately.**
Errors pile up and become hard to find. **Check:** open the reconcile screen for each bank and card account and read the last statement date.

- [ ] **7. Customer payments sit unapplied, or cash sits in "Undeposited Funds" for weeks.**
Reports show customers owing money they already paid. **Check:** the A/R aging report and the Undeposited Funds balance.

- [ ] **8. A vendor's prices crept up and nobody noticed.**
Small increases on a recurring bill add up all year. **Check:** compare this month's and last quarter's amounts for your five biggest vendors.

- [ ] **9. You're paying late fees or overdraft fees.**
These are the easiest costs to stop. **Check:** search expenses for "late fee," "overdraft" and "NSF" over the last 12 months.

- [ ] **10. You paid contractors but nobody tracked who may need a 1099.**
Missing paperwork can mean penalties and a January scramble. **Check:** the Vendor 1099 report, then confirm the current IRS threshold with your CPA.

## How many did you tick?

| | |
|---|---|
| **0–2** | Your books are probably in decent shape. Keep reconciling monthly. |
| **3–5** | Worth a closer look. Small problems here tend to grow. |
| **6+** | Your books are likely hiding information you need. A cleanup and a monthly review would pay off in clarity. |

## Want a second set of eyes? Book a free 20-minute call.

Every month I run my clients' QuickBooks files through a **52-point health scan** built in-house. It looks for all ten of these problems and 42 more, then ties every report back to QuickBooks to the cent. You get a two-page summary you can read in five minutes. I can't promise savings or results, but I'll look for them every month.

**(432) 231-3049** · benjaminbransonbookkeeping.com · Founding clients: Starter plan at $300/month for the first 12 months.

General information only, not tax, legal or accounting advice for your situation. QuickBooks Online menu names change from time to time. QuickBooks is a registered trademark of Intuit Inc.; Benjamin Branson Bookkeeping is not affiliated with Intuit.